CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 10: **Indian Architecture** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A traveller sees a shrine with a single carved hill, sculptures cut from top to bottom. This construction method suggests 1

(a) careful advance planning because errors cannot be undone
(b) cheap labour
(c) easy repair
(d) prefabrication

2. Why did Mughal architects use white marble in Shah Jahan's buildings? 1

(a) for elegance and the effect of light **(b)** it was local
(c) cheap **(d)** easy

3. Which clue shows that Chettinadu houses reflect trade links? 1

(a) mud walls **(b)** small rooms
(c) thatched roof **(d)** imported teak and marble

4. Which clue best suggests that Harappans valued public hygiene? 1

(a) wide roads **(b)** coins
(c) large forts **(d)** covered drains along streets

5. The courtyard of the Jama Masjid of Delhi can hold about 1

(a) 25,000 people **(b)** 2,50,000 people **(c)** 250 people **(d)** 2,500 people

6. A visitor sees a tank close to a temple. Which inference is most likely? 1

(a) it served ritual and water-storage needs **(b)** it was a market
(c) it was a fort moat **(d)** it was a harbour

7. Why might Dholavira's stone use be an adaptation? 1

(a) Stone was brought from the Himalayas
(b) Local geology gave stone instead of mud for bricks
(c) Its people had never seen bricks
(d) Bricks were banned by the rulers

8. The Indo-Saracenic style reveals the colonial rulers' wish to 1

(a) end trade
(b) appear rooted in India while displaying power
(c) copy Greece
(d) erase Indian art

9. Which of these is NOT a reason for building forts on hills? 1

(a) defence **(b)** natural barriers **(c)** easy farming **(d)** visibility

10. Which is a function of the stupa railing and torana besides decoration? 1

(a) define a sacred space and guide pilgrims **(b)** store grain

(c) produce light **(d)** defend

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why might ancient builders prefer to carve temples out of hills? 2

12. Why is the Ahmedabad Jama Masjid an example of syncretism? 2

13. What does the layout of a stepwell reveal about community life? 2

14. What inference can be made from donor names on a stupa railing? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Analyse how geography influenced Harappan building materials and designs. 3

16. Examine how temples served as centres of learning and arts. 3

17. Discuss the symbolism in the plan of the Golden Temple. 3

OR

Interpret the significance of the absence of the Buddha's image in early stupas. 3

18. Compare terracotta temples of Bengal with stone temples of Tamil Nadu. 3

OR

Compare Rajasthan's haveli and Tamil Nadu's Chettinadu house. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Critically examine how the Harappans combined planning, material and engineering skill. 5

OR

Compare the contributions of Akbar and Shah Jahan to architecture. 5

20. Trace the development of Buddhist architecture and its symbolism. 5

OR

Evaluate the Indo-Saracenic style as a statement of colonial power. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks